Jan Lukas Schäfer

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CEMFI

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Education

PhD in Economics 2020 – 2026 (expected)
CEMFI, Madrid, Spain. Advisor: Rafael Repullo

Master in Economics | **Honours Degree of Bachelor of Economics (First Class)** 2018 – 2020
Double Degree University of Tübingen, Germany & University of Adelaide, Australia

Bachelor of Science in International Economics 2015 – 2018
University of Tübingen, Germany with exchange at University of Queensland, Australia

References

Rafael Repullo (advisor)
CEMFI
repullo@cemfi.es

Javier Suárez
CEMFI
suarez@cemfi.es

Anatoli Segura
Banca d'Italia
anatolisegura@gmail.com

Research fields

Banking, Finance, Macroeconomics

Research

"Transmission of Negative Interest Rates: Reversal or Amplification?"
Featured in the *44th International Banking Library Newsletter*

Abstract: Negative monetary policy rates have been introduced in various advanced economies since the mid 2010s. Previous studies have shown that banks are hesitant to set negative deposit rates, implying losses in deposit taking that erode equity and eventually have a negative impact on the lending of capital constrained banks. I show that when banks are not constrained by their equity, equilibrium loan rates are lower under negative interest rates in the presence of a deposit ZLB (D-ZLB) than in its absence. Thus, policy rate cuts in negative territory might stimulate the economy even more than in positive territory, provided that sufficiently many banks are not capital constrained. In a calibrated dynamic model, the effect is large and dominates the effect due to equity erosion, with the D-ZLB increasing aggregate loan supply by on average 6% when policy rates are negative.

"ECB Euro Liquidity Lines" with Silvia Albrizio, Iván Kataryniuk and Luis Molina
Accepted at International Journal of Central Banking, July 2025 (Revised Version of IMF WP 23/96)
VOXEU article, SUERF article, BdE Research Features

Abstract: Central bank liquidity lines have gained importance as a cross-currency liquidity management tool with the intention to prevent threats to financial stability. We provide a complete timeline of ECB liquidity line announcements and quantify their signaling effect. The premium to borrow euros in FX markets is estimated to decrease by 51 basis points upon announcement. Moreover, we test for spillbacks and find that bank stock prices increase by around 2.1% in euro area countries highly exposed via banking linkages to currencies targeted by liquidity lines. The mechanism behind this novel result is illustrated in a stylized bank default model.

"Negative Interest Rates With Risky Banks: A Welfare Analysis in General Equilibrium"
(in progress)

Abstract: Negative monetary policy rates have been introduced in various advanced economies since the mid 2010s. Previous studies have shown that banks are hesitant to set negative deposit rates. This lack of transmission into deposit rates implies that banks face losses on deposits when policy rates fall sufficiently. To assess the effects of negative monetary policy rates in general equilibrium, I develop and calibrate a New Keynesian model featuring a deposit ZLB and endogenous loan defaults. While on average the impact on financial stability of a lower bound on monetary policy rates is slightly negative in equilibrium, loan volumes are larger and welfare is higher when the central bank commits to monetary policy rates above the rate at which banks start to make losses on deposits.

"Should Banks' Regulatory Capital Reflect Unrealized Capital Gains And Losses? A Quantitative Assessment" with Vedant Agarwal (in progress)

Abstract: We develop a quantitative general equilibrium model of risky banks with a bond portfolio subject to interest rate risk and consider the implications of having the unrealized capital gains or losses of such a portfolio excluded from the (amortized-cost accounting) or included in the (fair-value accounting) definition of regulatory capital. We show that when the unrealized gains or losses are excluded, banks are better isolated from short- term volatility in securities returns, resulting in a smoother credit supply. However, this accounting treatment increases the probability of bank failure during prolonged periods of intense monetary policy tightening. Under our calibration, fair-value is superior to amortized-cost accounting accounting in welfare terms.

Conference Presentations

Econometric Society Winter Meeting 2025 (scheduled)

1st Madrid Macro Mountain Conference (September 2025, Poster session)

Essex Finance Centre Conference in Banking and Corporate Finance (June 2025)

Discussions at conferences

"Collateral requirements, cost of credit, and firms' discouragement from applying for bank loans" by P. Arca, G. Atzeni and L. Deidda (Essex Finance Centre Conference in Banking and Corporate Finance, Rimini, June 2025)

Research & Professional Experience

CEMFI Sep 2022 – Present
Research Assistant to Prof. Enrique Sentana and Prof. Nezih Guner, Coordinator of the Banking & Finance Workshop, Course Manager Cemfi Summer School 2023 Madrid, Spain

Bank of Spain July 2021 – Sep 2021
International Economics and Euro Area Department Madrid, Spain

Research into ECB Euro Liquidity Lines

Deutsche Bundesbank Jan. 2020 - April 2020
Directorate General Financial Stability Frankfurt a.M., Germany
Calculation of optimal countercyclical capital buffers for Germany using DSGE models

University of Tübingen Sep. 2018 – Mar. 2019
Research Assistant to Prof. Georg Wamser, Chair of Public Economics Tübingen, Germany

Teaching experience

Math Camp, CEMFI (Graduate course) September 2023, 2024 & 2025
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Dante Amengual Madrid, Spain

Economics of Banking, CEMFI (Graduate course) Fall 2022
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Javier Suarez Madrid, Spain

Introduction to Mathematical Economics, Advanced (Undergraduate course) Semester 2, 2019
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Virginie Masson Adelaide, Australia

Public Economics (Undergraduate course) Winter Semester, 2018/2019
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Georg Wamser Tübingen, Germany

Mathematical Methods for Economics (Undergraduate course) Winter Semester, 2016/2017
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Thomas Dimpfl Tübingen, Germany

Scholarships and awards

2022 – 2026: PhD Scholarship (MCIN/AEI, FPI Grant PRE2022-099907)
Awarded by Spain's State Research Agency (PRE2022-101467)

2023: CEMFI Best Third Year Paper Award
Awarded for "Negative Interest Rates & Bank Fragility"

2020 – 2022: María de Maeztu Scholarship (MDM-2016-0684)

2019: University of Adelaide School of Economics Price for Best Overall Honours Result

Aug. 2017 – Nov. 2017: Baden-Württemberg Scholarship
Merit-based scholarship for study abroad

Apr. 2017 – Apr. 2018 & Apr. 2019 - Apr. 2020: Deutschland Stipendium
Merit-based one-year scholarship awarded on two separate occasions.

Other Information

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), Catalan (intermediate), French (intermediate), Arabic (beginner)

Programming: MATLAB, Julia, STATA, R, Dynare, LaTeX

Nationality: German

Year of birth: 1996